

Phase 5: Project Development

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID	SWTID-2026-3502	Team Size	5
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1. Overview

This phase explains how the solution was built in ServiceNow. Development followed three milestones: creating the flow, assigning it to the Standard Laptop catalog item and placing an order to verify the result.

2. Milestone 1: Create the Flow

Activity 1: Create a flow to create a catalog task

- 1 Open ServiceNow, click **All** and search for **Flow Designer**.
- 2 Click Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- 3 Click **New** and select **Flow**.
- 4 In Flow properties, set Flow name to **Standard laptop task**, Application to **Global** and Run As to **System User**, then click **Submit**.
- 5 Click **Add a trigger**, search for **Service Catalog**, select it and click **Done**.
- 6 Under Actions, click **Add an action**, search for **Create Catalog Task** and select it.
- 7 Drag the **Requested Item** record from the trigger into the Request Item field. The table auto-populates as Catalog Task [sc_task].
- 8 Enter the short description **Laptop needs to Configured**.
- 9 Click **Add field value** and add: Description = Laptop needs to Configured; Assignment group = Hardware; Approval = Approved.
- 10 Leave the remaining fields as default and click **Done**.
- 11 Click **Save**, then **Activate**, and confirm by clicking Activate again.

Setting	Value
Flow name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run As	System User
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Table	Catalog Task [sc_task]

Setting	Value
Request Item	Trigger > Requested Item
Short description	Laptop needs to Configured
Fields	Description, Assignment group (Hardware), Approval (Approved)
Status	Active

3. Milestone 2: Flow Assignment

Activity 1: Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item

- 1 Open ServiceNow, click **All** and search for **Maintain Items**.
- 2 Select Maintain Items and search for **Standard Laptop** in the Name field; open the record.
- 3 Open the **Process Engine** tab.
- 4 Remove any other automations and add **Flow**.
- 5 Select the flow named **Standard Laptop task**.
- 6 Use the menu to save (Update) the record.

4. Milestone 3: Service Catalog Ordering and Approval

Activity 1: Place the order and get approval

- 1 Click **All**, search for **Service Catalog**, open it and click **Hardware**.
- 2 Open **Standard Laptop** and click **Order Now**.
- 3 On the Order Status page, click the Request Number.
- 4 On the request record, scroll to the **Approvers** tab.
- 5 Right-click the approval record and choose **Approve**.
- 6 Open the **Requested Items** tab and open the requested item (RITM).
- 7 Scroll to **Catalog Tasks** and open the task to confirm the short description and Hardware assignment group.

5. Result Observed

After approval, a catalog task was generated automatically under the requested item, with the short description and the Hardware assignment group set by the flow. The sample run recorded Request REQ0010001, Requested Item RITM0010001 and Catalog Task SCTASK0010001, assigned to the Hardware group.

6. Challenges and Solutions

Challenge	Solution
Flow did not start for the catalog item	Added the flow in the item's Process Engine tab and confirmed it was Active

Challenge	Solution
Only one process engine can be selected	Removed existing workflow or execution plan entries before adding the flow
Request Item mapping missing	Dragged the Requested Item data pill from the trigger
Task not visible to the Hardware team	Checked the Assignment group value was Hardware

7. Outcome of the Phase

The automated flow was built, activated, attached to the Standard Laptop item and verified through an end-to-end order.